



7. **Justice:** If the traditional doctrine is true, God's judgment

4. If the traditional doctrine is true, God sends one people (group

1. **Non-universality:** If the traditional doctrine is true, some people

very, very much worse off than people in heaven.

A) to heaven and everyone else (group B) to hell. (1, 2, 3)

God who goes to heaven and who goes to hell.

2.Divine control: If the traditional doctrine is true, it is up to

3. **Dichotomy:** If the traditional doctrine is true, there are exactly

two states in the afterlife, heaven and hell.

off than group B. (4, 5)

5. **Badness:** If the traditional doctrine is true, people are hell

go to heaven, and so to hell.

6 If the traditional doctrine is true, God makes group A much better

persons who are very similar in their level and proportion

8. **Proportionality**: justice prohibits very unequal treatment

about who goes to heaven & hell is just.

9. If the traditional doctrine is true, no one in group A is very

similar in their relevant properties to any one in group B. (6, 7, 8)

10. **Continuity:** There is no way of dividing all people into two groups

properties to anyone in the other group.

so that none in one group is similar in their level



C. The traditional doctrine of heaven and hell is false. (9, 10)

Let's try to layout Sider's reasoning by isolating the various features of the

the existence of a perfectly good God.

traditional doctrine of heaven and hell that he thinks are inconsistent with

“A certain traditional conception of the afterlife is *binary*. After death one proceeds either to heaven or hell. Heaven is very, very good; hell is very, very bad. There are no possibilities for the afterlife other than heaven and hell, and membership in heaven or hell is never indeterminate or a matter of degree. The problem with the binary conception is that it contradicts God's justice. God must employ some criterion to decide who goes to heaven and who goes to hell. No reasonable criterion would be sharp; any reasonable criterion will have borderline cases. But the binary conception of the afterlife allows for no corresponding fuzziness in how the dead are to be treated. Hell must therefore contain people who are nearly indiscernible in relevant respects from people in Heaven. No just God would allow such a monstrously unfair thing.”

heaven and hell based on certain properties of these people. We will have

Let's call them the relevant properties.

open for what those properties might be; just have a name for them,

It is part of the traditional doctrine that God decides whether people go to





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replies to the
paradox



evil & lives
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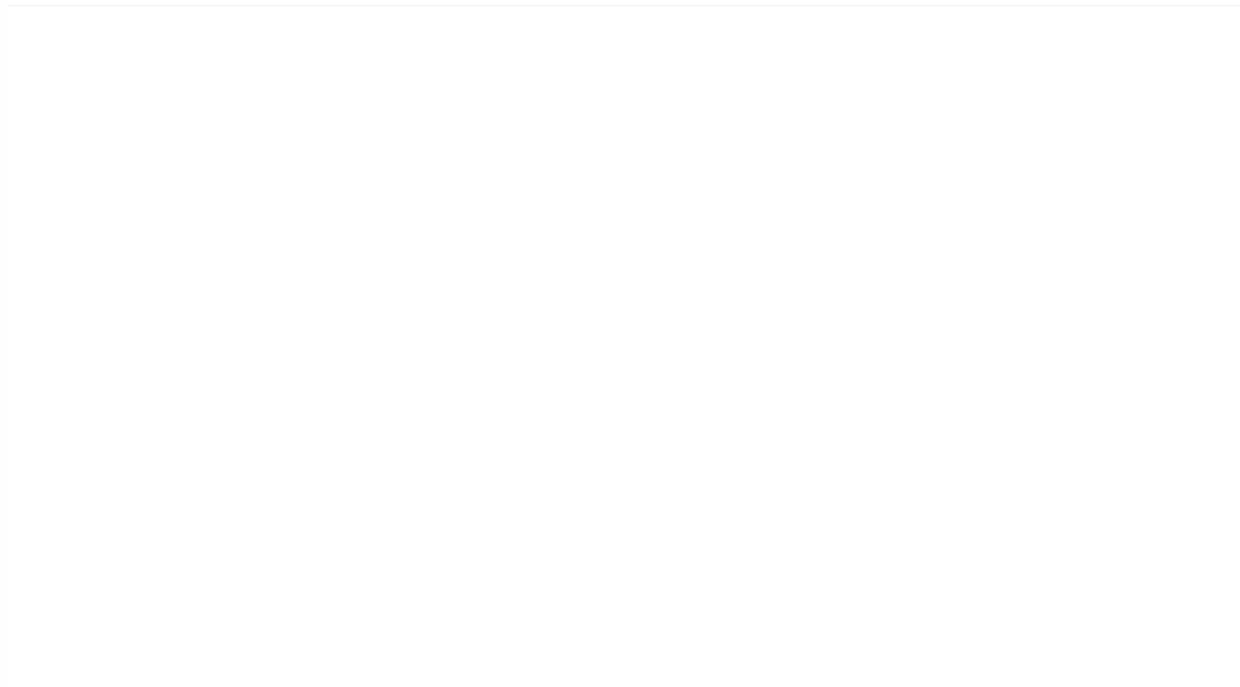
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The following passage from the Catechism of the Catholic Church

describes the kind of view wanted to discuss:



eternis!

1038. The resurrection of all the dead, 'of both the

Judgment. Christ will come "in his glory, and all

the angels with him... Before him will be gathered

just and the unjust,' will precede the Last

another as a shepherd separates the sheep from the

goats, and he will place the sheep at his right hand,

all the nations, and he will separate them one from

but the goats at the left.... and they will go away

into external punishment, but the rights into

One topic often associated with belief in God is the topic of life after death.

perfectly good Good?

Our first question today is: what we are told about life after death by

many of the major monotheistic religions practiced with the existence of a



goats, and the wild prairie sheep at his

the Last Judgment. . . Christ will come "in

as a shepherd separates the sheep from the

both the just and the unjust," will proceed

right hand, but the goat at the left... and

this glory, and all the angels with him.

1038. The reservation of the dead, "of

but the rights are all in it.

Before him will be gathered all the nations,

and the wild sheep are then from another

they will go away into eternal punishment,

judgement on all of us, and on the basis of our life, decides that some of us will

got to heaven forever, and some others to hell forever. (If not 'forever', then the

talk of the last judgment wouldn't make much sense.)

This certainly seems like a picture according to which, after death, God passes

must depend on the possibility of life after death. We will now ask: is the kind of

Turned-in showed why it is plausible that respo to the argument from evil

view of life after death we get here on pain of being perfectly good?



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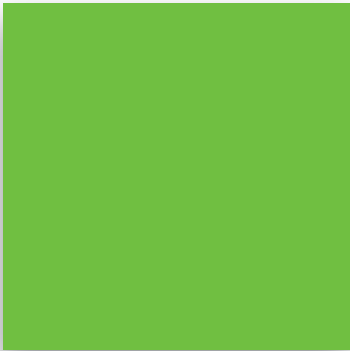
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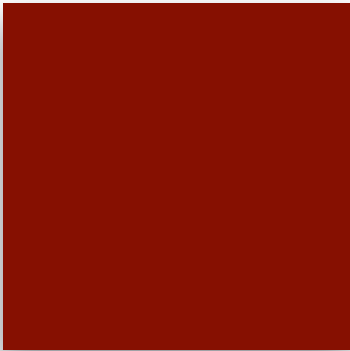












It seems difficult to deny Justice, Badness, or Divine Control. So that

seems to give the defender of the afterlife further main options.









